

Change Management Policy

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This policy establishes a structured framework for managing changes to systems, software, and infrastructure, ensuring minimal disruption, compliance with industry standards, and alignment with organizational goals. The Jira ticketing system is integral to tracking, documenting, and executing changes efficiently.

1.2 Scope

Applies to all employees, contractors, and stakeholders involved in proposing, approving, or implementing changes to production systems, codebases, or IT infrastructure. Covers software development, IT operations, and third-party integrations.

1.3 Objectives

- Minimize risks associated with changes.
- Ensure traceability and accountability through Jira.
- Maintain compliance with regulatory requirements.
- Foster collaboration and communication across teams.

1.4 Exceptions

Emergency changes (e.g., critical security patches) may bypass standard workflows but require retroactive documentation and CMB approval within 24 hours.

2. Governance

2.1 Change Management Board (CMB)

- **Role:** Oversee policy compliance, review major changes, and approve exceptions.
- **Membership:** IT Director, Security Lead, QA Manager, Legal/Compliance Representative.

2.2 Roles and Responsibilities

- **Change Owner:** Submits and oversees the change (e.g., Project Manager).
- **Implementer:** Executes the change (e.g., Developer, SysAdmin).
- **Reviewer:** Conducts risk/impact assessments and verifies code changes.
 - **Note:** The person committing the code **cannot** serve as the reviewer for the same change.
- **QA Team:** Validates testing and approves deployments to production.

3. Change Classification

Type	Description	Approval Required
Standard	Low-risk, pre-approved changes (e.g., UI tweaks).	Team Lead
Major	High-impact changes (e.g., database migration).	CMB
Emergency	Urgent fixes (e.g., security vulnerabilities).	CMB (post-implementation approval)

4. Change Management Process

4.1 Request Submission

- **Jira Ticket Creation:**
 - All changes require a Jira ticket with fields for:
 - Title, Description, and Business Justification.
 - Impact Level (Low/Medium/High).
 - Associated Risks and Rollback Plan.
 - Use standardized issue types (e.g., “Change Request,” “Bug,” “Feature”).

4.2 Assessment and Planning

- **Risk Analysis:** Reviewers evaluate technical, security, and operational impacts.
- **Jira Updates:** Attach impact assessments, test plans, and stakeholder feedback to the ticket.

4.3 Approval Workflow

- **Automated Transitions:** Configure Jira workflows to route tickets based on change type:
 - **Standard:** Auto-approve after team lead review.
 - **Major:** Escalate to CMB with @mentions and priority flags.

4.4 Implementation

- **Code Commits:**
 - Developers must link commits to Jira tickets (e.g., “PROJ-123”).
 - The committer of the code must not be assigned as the verifying reviewer in Jira.
- **Peer Review:**
 - A separate individual (peer or senior developer) performs code review to ensure code quality, security, and alignment with project requirements.

- Any identified blockers must be logged in the Jira ticket for resolution.
- **Testing:**
 - QA teams update Jira with test results and CI/CD pipeline statuses.
 - Failed tests trigger automatic ticket reassignment or re-opening.

4.5 Post-Implementation Review

- **Verification:** Confirm functionality in production; update Jira status to “Done.”
 - **Documentation:** Attach post-mortems, user feedback, and monitoring reports to the ticket.
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5. Communication Plan

- **Pre-Implementation:** Notify stakeholders via Jira comments or linked Confluence pages.
 - **During Implementation:** Use Jira dashboards for real-time status tracking.
 - **Post-Implementation:** Automate release notes from resolved Jira tickets.
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6. Testing and Validation

- **Environments:**
 - **Development:** Unit testing.
 - **Staging:** Integration/load testing (results logged in Jira).
 - **Approval Gates:** QA adds “Approved for Prod” label before deployment.
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7. Deployment and Rollback

- **CI/CD Integration:**
 - Jira tickets transition to “Deployed” upon successful pipeline execution.
 - **Rollback:**
 - Trigger via Jira by re-opening the ticket; automated pipelines revert changes.
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8. Training and Awareness

- **Jira Workflows:**
 - Quarterly workshops on ticket creation, labeling, and workflow navigation.
- **Change Management:**
 - Annual training on risk assessment and compliance requirements.

9. Compliance and Auditing

- **Audit Trail:**
 - Jira history logs (ticket updates, approvals, etc.) retained for 7 years (or per organizational policy).
- **Penalties:**
 - Non-compliance (e.g., untracked changes) results in mandatory retraining or escalation to the CMB.

10. Continuous Improvement

- **Feedback Loop:**
 - Biweekly retrospectives to refine Jira workflows.
- **Policy Reviews:**
 - CMB evaluates policy effectiveness biannually and updates as needed.

11. Definitions

- **Jira Ticket:** A digital record in Jira that tracks change details, approvals, and outcomes.
- **CI/CD:** Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment pipelines automating code testing and deployment tied to Jira statuses.
- **CMB (Change Management Board):** The governing body that oversees and approves major changes or exceptions.

Policy Adoption:

- Customize Jira fields, workflows, and SLAs to align with organizational needs.
- Integrate with monitoring tools (e.g., Datadog, Splunk) for enhanced visibility.
- Ensure training materials reflect the requirement that the committer cannot verify their own changes.

This version explicitly **prohibits the same individual from committing and verifying code**, maintaining proper segregation of duties and ensuring robust quality control.